

MIKE E. UNDERWOOD

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Summary

Principal/Staff Solutions Architect with deep experience designing, modernizing, and delivering large-scale payment, billing, CMS, and enterprise platforms across .NET, Java, cloud, and legacy environments. Known for combining hands-on engineering depth with architectural leadership to shape roadmaps, define integration patterns, guide DEV/QA teams, and resolve complex system issues across APIs, data, and infrastructure. Recognized for modernizing platforms, reducing delivery timelines, improving reliability, and aligning technical direction with business strategy. Additional writing, system-design thinking, and engineering projects are available at mikeeunderwood.dev.

Skills & Technical Expertise

Core Languages & Platforms

- C#, Java, C++, JavaScript/TypeScript
- Python (automation, scripting, orchestration)
- SQL (T-SQL, MySQL/MariaDB; schema design, stored procedures, performance tuning)

Application & Integration Frameworks

- .NET / ASP.NET Core (API design, middleware, service composition)
- ASP.NET MVC (legacy modernization, UI architecture)
- React, Vue.js, Node.js (front-end integration and headless CMS patterns)
- Sitecore, Optimizely (enterprise CMS architecture, content modeling, component design)

Cloud, Infrastructure & Platform Engineering

- Azure, AWS Lambda (serverless execution, event-driven patterns)
- CI/CD governance & automation (Azure Pipelines, GitHub Actions)
- Containerization & orchestration (Docker, Kubernetes), IIS, Windows, Red Hat Linux
- Observability architecture (Azure Application Insights, distributed tracing, telemetry pipelines)

Data & Integration Architecture

- SQL Server, Azure SQL Database, MySQL/MariaDB
- Data modeling, performance engineering, and modernization (on-prem → cloud-native)
- API-first design, service contracts, schema governance (REST/JSON, versioning strategies)

Enterprise Architecture & System Design

- Cloud-native modernization, domain-driven design, modular monolith → microservices transitions
- SOA, event-driven systems, messaging patterns (Azure Service Bus, asynchronous workflows)
- Compliance-driven architecture (PCI, HIPAA), secure system design, auditability
- Transaction workflow automation, multi-system orchestration, integration patterns

Leadership, Governance & Delivery Practices

- Enterprise & Solution Architecture, roadmap development, architectural standards
- Cross-functional leadership across engineering, product, security, and infrastructure teams
- Agile/SDLC governance (Azure DevOps, JIRA), DevOps enablement
- Stakeholder alignment, technical communication, distributed team collaboration

Reliability, Performance & Operational Excellence

- SRE-aligned architecture: reliability patterns, monitoring strategy, incident response frameworks
- Performance optimization, scalability engineering, capacity planning
- Automated testing strategy (unit, integration, API validation) and CI/CD quality gates
- Production readiness, release governance, and operational risk mitigation

Experience

Rightpoint Consulting — Remote, United States

Solutions Architect (Jan 2020 – Nov 2025)

- Designed technical architecture for enterprise CMS and retail/e-commerce platforms built on Sitecore, Optimizely, and ASP.NET Core, while contributing hands-on to key features and integrations.
- Built CMS presentation components using ASP.NET MVC and delivered headless experiences with React/TypeScript, ensuring alignment between architectural patterns and implementation quality.
- Developed backend payment workflows using C#/.NET Web APIs, AWS Lambda for serverless execution, and Azure Service Bus for asynchronous, event driven processing patterns supporting reliability and scale.

- Designed cloud deployment architectures across AKS, Azure VMs, and AWS Lambda-based serverless components; implemented CI/CD pipelines and observability instrumentation including Application Insights and distributed tracing.
- Diagnosed systemic issues using logs, metrics, and telemetry; implemented fixes across APIs, data access, and cloud infrastructure to improve performance and reliability.
- Mentored DEV/QA teams on implementation patterns, debugging, and code quality to preserve architectural intent through delivery.
- Authored API specifications, integration contracts, and architectural documentation; collaborated with security and compliance teams to ensure HIPAA-aligned integrations.
- Partnered with stakeholders to shape technical roadmaps, evaluate solution tradeoffs, and align delivery with long-term architectural strategy.

AXIS Capital — Alpharetta, GA

Application Delivery Lead, Corporate Systems (Mar 2018 – Dec 2019)

- Delivered software solutions aligned to business and segment CIO goals, ensuring architectural consistency and adherence to enterprise standards.
- Partnered with business stakeholders to define requirements and translate them into application and integration architectures aligned with Enterprise Architecture principles, security guidelines, and long-term platform strategy.
- Served as Scrum Master and team lead, planning and coordinating development activities, removing blockers, and ensuring predictable delivery across distributed teams.
- Led offshore DEV/QA teams, providing technical guidance, reviewing implementation approaches, and ensuring alignment with architectural direction.
- Managed delivery budgets, resource planning, and cross team coordination to support successful execution of software initiatives.
- Collaborated with support teams to troubleshoot production issues, improve system reliability, and ensure smooth operation of deployed solutions.

Fiserv — Alpharetta, GA

Dec 1999 – Feb 2018

Role progression: Senior Software Engineer → Software Architect → Senior Software Architect → Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect → Principal Solutions Architect

Principal Solutions Architect (Aug 2014 – Feb 2018)

- Partnered with senior leadership to define and maintain a three-year business and technology roadmap for the CheckFreePay division, ensuring architectural alignment with strategic goals.
- Analyzed business strategy and translated objectives into system architecture requirements, guiding platform evolution and long-term technical direction.
- Collaborated with product managers, business analysts, developers, and support teams to define project requirements, integration needs, and solution specifications.
- Developed strategic plans for component modernization and platform sustainability to support future business and regulatory objectives.
- Served as Scrum Master and team lead, coordinating planning, design, and implementation of software and hardware solutions across distributed teams.
- Chaired the Technical Review Board, governing promotion of walk-in payment solutions into production and ensuring architectural compliance and operational readiness.
- Oversaw production deployments and acted as a key escalation resource for diagnosing and resolving complex production issues across applications, infrastructure, and integrations.
- Provided technical leadership for the migration of all walk-in applications and databases from legacy environments to the go-forward Fiserv data center, including hands-on development (Informix 4GL/C → C#), scripting modernization (Unix → PowerShell), and database migration (Informix → SQL Server), along with infrastructure design and network configuration.
- Partnered with a Fiserv vendor to design and implement walk-in payments via retail barcode readers, eliminating data-entry errors and improving payment processing accuracy; delivered supporting .NET Web Service APIs.
- Redesigned compliance reporting and monitoring for walk-in payments, achieving 100% reporting accuracy and strengthening audit readiness.

Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect (Mar 2012 – Jul 2014)

- Managed the Biller Solutions architecture team, including hiring, coaching, and performance evaluation.
- Defined and maintained a three-year business roadmap and supporting architecture roadmap.
- Led implementation of modernization initiatives and a .NET Web Service API layer across .NET and Java products.

Senior Software Architect (Sep 2008 – Feb 2012)

- Served on the Architecture Review Board and partnered with product management to shape new Biller Solutions initiatives, aligning solution proposals, integration patterns, and long-term platform strategy.

- Designed and delivered multiple enterprise e-bill platforms, including the patent-pending eBill Easy Activation service (230% adoption increase), a cross-platform authentication mechanism reducing certificates from hundreds to one, and the .NET SaaS Web Service API that became the foundation for e-bill capabilities used by 4,000+ financial sponsors.
- Led architecture and delivery of major consumer experiences, including the responsive MyCheckFree.com mobile app (iOS/Android) with supporting Java REST APIs, and the .NET e-bill platform that cut implementation timelines from nine months to two and now underpins Fiserv's eBill Distribution™ product.

Software Architect (Jul 2001 – Aug 2008)

- Founding member of an Agile innovation group focused on rapidly prototyping new payment and billing concepts, applying lean discovery and iterative delivery to validate business opportunities.
- Designed and delivered multiple Java and ASP.NET payment solutions — including B2B workflows, retailer payment engines, and consumer payment portals — several of which were commercialized or sold to third parties.
- Led ASP.NET initiatives such as ACH orchestration, correspondence systems, and consumer payment flows integrated with CheckFree's mainframe platform, and developed a Tandem-based POS solution including a custom C++ Tandem emulator to accelerate early development.
- Participated in the migration of CheckFree's iSeries e-bill and payment toolkit from Toronto to Norcross following the BlueGill acquisition, ensuring continuity of biller-direct capabilities.
- Designed and implemented a Java biller-direct payment and presentment platform integrating iSeries and mainframe systems with HTML widget components, introducing a polymorphic API layer for biller-specific logic injection.
- Collaborated with the architecture team to design and evolve a .NET based Service Oriented Architecture (SOA) exposing mainframe payment and billing capabilities through domain, utility, business channel, and orchestration services; served as lead architect for e bill service components used across thousands of financial institutions

Senior Software Engineer (Dec 1999 – Jun 2001)

- Provided professional services consultation to CheckFree's sales teams and clients, guiding integration with CheckFree's e-bill and payment systems and shaping technical approaches during pre-sales and onboarding.
- Worked closely with project managers to develop project plans, estimates, and delivery timelines for client integration initiatives.
- Managed and executed project deliverables, ensuring solutions were delivered according to defined goals, requirements, and client expectations.
- Designed and implemented client integration solutions ranging from simple SSO implementations to full client-hosted solutions leveraging API interfaces into CheckFree's payment and e-bill platforms.

RIB Software (formerly Building Systems Design) — Atlanta, GA

Senior Software Engineer (Jul 1991 – Nov 1999)

- Engineered cost-estimation and lifecycle-management capabilities adopted by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, improving project accuracy and analytical decision-making.
- Co-architected and developed BSD SpecLink, an automated building-specification SaaS platform that became the foundation for 1,000+ construction projects.
- BSD SpecLink (now RIB SpecLink) remains a leading construction-specification platform in active commercial use decades later.
- Guided product-suite evolution to improve scalability, reduce long-standing technical debt, and streamline release cycles.
- Delivered enterprise-grade solutions in C++, database design, and systems integration, improving system reliability and accelerating delivery workflows.

Sales Technologies — Buckhead, GA

Software Engineer (Jul 1990 – Jun 1991)

- Built modular C++ features for a sales-force automation platform adopted by major sales organizations.

Universal Microsystems — Peachtree Corners, GA

Software Engineer (Jul 1987 – Jun 1990)

- Delivered custom enterprise software solutions for clients including Coca-Cola and Siemens, automating business processes across diverse environments.

Education

Master of Science: Computer Information Systems

Georgia State University: J. Mack Robinson College of Business

1989
Atlanta, Georgia, United States

BBA: Computer Information Systems

Georgia State University: J. Mack Robinson College of Business

1986
Atlanta, Georgia, United States.

Certifications

Sitecore Experience Solution 9 Developer (Aug 2020)

LinkedIn Learning: Cloud Architect Core Concepts, Creating Your IT Strategy (2018)